modifications at a general meeting.[3] The topics included quotas and voting power, obligations of member countries, withdrawal or suspension of members, and change in parities.

While these meetings were held at Atlantic City, the British delegation headed by Keynes sailed for the United States. Keynes along with Lionel Robbins, Sir Wilfred Eady, and Dennis Robertson among others, sailed on June 16 on the *Queen Mary* from Southampton. Heavy work during the voyage produced two 'boat drafts' covering the Bank and the Fund. The group landed in New York City on June 23 and soon after traveled by train to Atlantic City. Keynes had developed keen enthusiasm for the Bank which he saw as a more rational investment engine than the 'ill-conceived racket' which had followed the last war 'but he saw it as an agency more for post-war European reconstruction than for long-term development.[4] The Bank was barely discussed by the US Treasury. White who was obsessed with the Fund had little time for the Bank.

Keynes and White decided to agree to a text behind the scenes but agreed to present alternatives to the delegates at Bretton Woods, having decided in advance which alternatives they would drop or press. White realized that without British support nothing could be achieved. And since British support meant Keynes's support, he made every attempt to conciliate him. White agreed that the members of the Fund should be allowed to devalue without the permission of the Fund and they could decide the lengths of their own transitional periods. Questions concerning the size of the quotas, 'policing' and management, and location of the Fund and the Bank were left to be discussed at the main Conference at Bretton Woods. Keynes himself rarely attended the plenary sessions where White held court. Keynes had a heart condition and exhaustion was setting in, made worse by the incessant work, meetings, and nervous excitement. However, Britain's financial dependence on the United States meant that it would be White and the Americans who would have their way while putting on an appearance of cooperation. Morgenthau, as noted before, was nominally in charge but it was White who called the shots on all important issues and arranged everything from press conferences to having transcripts typed and distributed. White was the only one 'who knows the complete matter' and 'who can prevent a vote on anything he doesn't want voted on.'[5]